

BRAVE NEW WORDS From admission to revelation to tittle-tattle, they are saying it all

"Maine kaam pane ke liye sab kuch kiya hai par woh nahin kiya. Yahan tak ki maine chote kapde bhi pehne."

(I've done everything to get work but not 'that'. I've even worn revealing dresses.)

RAKHI SAWANT to Ram Kapoor *Rakhi ka Swayamvar*

"She was nice but I couldn't keep up with her decadent lifestyle. A lot of times when I came home, her friends would be there. My house used to smell like 'heaven'."

MARC ROBINSON on Preity Zinta to Mona Vasu *Iss Jungle se Mujhe Bachao*

RAJEEV KHANDELWAL
asks **URVASHI DHOLAKIA**

Sacch ka Saamna

"Were you thrown out of college for getting pregnant at a young age?"

She answers, "No" but clarifies that she wasn't thrown out but left college herself after getting pregnant.

"What percentage of Indian couples don't have sex on their wedding night?"

ANSWER 45 per cent

"What percentage of Indians have spied on their partners' call and SMS records?"

ANSWER 33 per cent

Kareena and Karisma Kapoor, who were on the episode, thought it was 85 per cent.

10 ka Dum



"Tum woh beej ho jo deewar par ugti hai to deewar barbaad kar deti hai. Aur ab tum meri aur meri biwi ki zindagi barbaad karna chahti ho"
(You are the seed that destroys the wall it grows on. And now you want to destroy my married life.)

SHEKHAR TO LAALI

Agle Janam Mujhe Bitiya hi Kijo

113mn
is the number
of viewers of
Hindi general
entertainment
channels
in India.

55%
of the target
audience are
women, which
explains why
most shows
focus on the
tortured girl
syndrome.

Kiran Bedi back at 8.30 p.m., to include a wider audience. Sony, that achieved moderate success with *Entertainment Ke Liye Kuch Bhi Karega* that got a TRP of 2.5, is returning with a second season barely three months after the first, with its mix of handicapped dancers, fire-eaters and tongue-piercers.

Colors is also charging ahead. Apart from *India's Got Talent*, which is already on air and has seen oddities like a cross-dresser from Ranchi who does Kathakali or an arthritic patient who lives for dance, *Khatron Ke Khiladi*'s second season will debut soon with Akshay Kumar jumping out of choppers and fighting alligators. *Bigg Boss 3* is on the anvil too and though channel heads agree that producing a high profile show is more expensive, the returns are significant too. If one episode of a top-rated soap costs anywhere between Rs 5 and Rs 6 lakh, a reality show without any star hosts costs between Rs 15 and Rs 20 lakh. The cost increases when Akshay Kumar or Salman Khan take charge. It could then run up to Rs 1-2 crore including the actor's fee. But ad rates are higher too. If a prime time show on a top-rated channel like Star Plus or Colors

commands Rs 80,000 to Rs 1 lakh for 10 seconds, a reality show on the same channel commands anything between Rs 1.5 lakh and Rs 2 lakh. The rates decrease depending on the numbers game. A channel like Sony or NDTV Imagine would get Rs 60,000 and Rs 70,000 per 10 seconds for a fiction show while their reality shows would get Rs 80,000 to Rs 1 lakh. Reality shows now constitute close to 20 per cent of the total GEC programming and advertisers view them as good investments because of their reach and recall.

Though the new crop of programmes has MPs hot under the collar, for once the Government seems to have seen sense. Newly installed Minister for Information and Broadcasting Ambika Soni says she has no desire to police 480 channels. She has had three meetings with stakeholders and will now be initiating a fresh set of discussions on the draft of the Broadcasting Bill which is on the ministry website. "We need a discussion with civil society as well before we put in an independent, autonomous broadcasting regulator. It will not be another Censor Board," she says. As Soni points out, there has to be a balance between freedom and sensitivity, between the evolving social mindset and accepted conventions.

If that is not *sacch ka saamna*, what is? ■